

Revolution Group call_Rick Snide & Jason Snyder_Business Development Mgr-20260608_080032-Meeting Transcript

June 8, 2026, 12:00PM

49m 6s

● **Rick Snide** started transcription



Rick Snide 0:03

Definitely better.

Definitely better the.



Jason S 0:06

Good.



Rick Snide 0:08

Hopefully you aren't hearing a bunch of background noise for me. I've got this headphone, these headphones on. I've got my one of my kids and two granddaughters who are four and one are here and they are running circles around the house, basically.



Jason S 0:23

Wonderful.

Worries.

Well, good. I'm glad they're here having a good time in the summer.



Rick Snide 0:32

Yeah, yeah, it's they're here for one more day. They're from Charleston, South Carolina, so they're here for one more day, so yeah, but I wanted to get a chance to talk to you and...



Jason S 0:35

Play.

Mhm.

That's good.



Rick Snide 0:46

You know, early morning is usually manageable before things get totally, totally out of control.



Jason S 0:54

100%.



Rick Snide 0:55

So, where are you located?



Jason S 0:57

I live in Grandview.



Rick Snide 0:58

Oh, and Grandview, okay. Love Grandview.



Jason S 0:59

Yes, it's wonderful. I'm so lucky to be here. My kids are doing great in school. It's a really nice community. How are you?



Rick Snide 1:06

Yeah, yeah, I'm in Westerville, so...



Jason S 1:10

Wonderful as well. Great. It really exploded.



Rick Snide 1:11

Similar, yeah, yeah, yeah, similar. You don't quite have, I like having, you know, Grandview being next to like Arlington and then the, you know, you're close to being right in the city right there, so you've got that benefit, but Westerville is.

 **Jason S** 1:25
Yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 1:30
is a good spot. Just, yeah, yeah. So good. So how'd you hear about us in this role?

 **Jason S** 1:32
Wonderful.
So, I would, obviously, you know, I don't know if what I should say, obviously I was looking at it through LinkedIn. I am, yeah, I'm currently employed. I am leaving my company, and so I was obviously looking for open positions. So, in the Revolution, the Revolution Group has, I've seen it many times, so I'm excited as out with you.

 **Rick Snide** 1:45
LinkedIn, okay.
Gotcha.
M.
Okay, good, good. What, um, what do you know about us, would you say?

 **Jason S** 2:06
Excuse me. So I know historically you've been mainly managed services, SAP, Salesforce, development, ERP, you know, along those lines. Obviously you become the IT department for small to medium businesses, non-profit, you know, SLED, and

 **Rick Snide** 2:11
Mhm.
Mhm.

 **Jason S** 2:24
I've been in the technology world, mainly in the contact center, UCAS, CCAS world for the past 17 years. So it's a really good fit for me because managed services seems to be just so hot right now because nobody can afford an IT department. So we need out there, everybody's outsourcing stuff, whether it's service desk, whether it's



Rick Snide 2:31

Mhm.

Mhm.



Jason S 2:44

this or that. And the company I work for now actually is a Microsoft AI solutions provider. So we work with a lot of managed services partners to be their professional services arm. So I'm working with them with managed services partners A lot. So



Rick Snide 2:54

M.

The and when you say AI services or AI arm, what, what, what are you providing?



Jason S 3:09

Microsoft. It's all Microsoft AI, all co-pilot. So, but I've delved into more of the AI, like the agentic AI, the, you know, more on the agent side as opposed to the co-pilot side, which is really more of a widget for Outlook as opposed to actual agentic AI. So,



Rick Snide 3:23

Mm-hmm.

Mm-hmm.

Yeah, yeah, right, right. Are you doing that, some of that yourself, or are you just connecting and selling?



Jason S 3:41

connecting and selling. Yeah, I am, I'm not, I'm not, I'm not technical. I'm enough to get to be dangerous to have a good conversation, to get things moving. But I would not say I'm not a programmer. I'm not a sales engineer. I'm a channel manager. You know, I run the, I'm a hunter. That's what I do. I don't want to get bogged down with the technology side of it.



Rick Snide 3:46

M.

Mm-hmm.

Mhm, mhm.

Mm-hmm.

JS **Jason S** 4:02

But I can absorb enough for being in this industry for almost 20 years to have an intelligent conversation.

 **Rick Snide** 4:02

Mhm.

Yeah, yeah, well you have to have at least a little bit of technical chops to be able to talk about agentic AI with people.

JS **Jason S** 4:15

Absolutely. And, you know, there's a lot of high-level, you know, qualifications and understanding that you can get to without having a technical resource.

 **Rick Snide** 4:26

Anything else on that technical side that you're used to? So you're normally, it looks like your whole career has been channel focused, working with partners of different stripes and now a lot of managed service type customers, I suppose. But

JS **Jason S** 4:44

Correct, but I also sell directly. You know, I'm closing the deals. I'm carrying, you know, I have a \$2.4 million quota. You know, we do have a direct sales team, but they don't know how to work with the channel.

 **Rick Snide** 4:44

Yeah, so.

M.

So, what, so when you say you're selling directly, what are you selling directly, you know, yourself?

JS **Jason S** 5:02

the services that I'm working with right now. What I've always done in channel is I'm working, obviously, with the vendors, bringing opportunities to the direct team, and

then the direct team allegedly takes that and closes it with the end user. But now, more and more channel reps are closing deals themselves, and then the direct reps get a small cut because they may own the account.



Rick Snide 5:15

Mhm.

M.

Mhm.



Jason S 5:25

But it doesn't.

It's very much a...

closing role that I'm in. You know, I'm closing, so anyway, I just want to make sure that you knew that. I'm not really, I'm an overlay, but I'm still working with the end users, so.



Rick Snide 5:33

I gotcha.

Okay, good. Yeah, that's good to know. So...



Jason S 5:46

I.



Rick Snide 5:46

Do you?

I guess my question is along the lines of...

talking about our kind of customer that we work with. So we typically, we have really kind of two categories of customers in terms of size. They would all fall into the government's definition of SMB.



Jason S 5:55

Yeah.



Rick Snide 6:13

you know, which is like 2500 users and below, right? But, you know, the normal, you

know, us kind of people, you know, our definition of SMB is much smaller, really. I typically, I called, you know, 0 to, or let's say 1 to 250, I call that SMB, and I called.

 **Jason S** 6:23

I.
Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 6:34

250 plus mid-market. We had, just as a quick note, we had three separate but co-managed businesses, you know, that had some overlap. Even if you're looking at our website today, we're in the process of...

 **Jason S** 6:38

Yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 6:54

We're doing it right now. So we had a Salesforce consulting business. We sold that three years ago. We had a, the one that you can still see on there is the Plex ERP consulting business, which that was, that company was bought by, the Plex that is, was bought by Rockwell Automation.

 **Jason S** 6:59

Okay.
Yeah.
Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 7:15

A few years ago, and we sold that at this just last month, sold our ERP business last month, so our remaining business that we have is our managed services business, which is, yeah, which is so we all of the dev, we had all kinds of...

 **Jason S** 7:29

Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 7:35

Well, Salesforce consulting is a lot of dev, especially the way that we approached it. The ERP consulting had a pretty big dev component to it too. Our managed services business doesn't have any dev at all now. It's pure managed service, pure play managed service. So

And we have, as I was starting to tell you, two kind of categories in terms of size. That SMB size, we go as low as 10, 15 users, but we've got a minimum dollar amount. I mean, you could.

You can sign up for our services, but you're going to pay our minimum if you only, you know, rather, you know, until you get up to about 15 users, you're going to pay the 15 user price. And we do that up to, we do that as our like fully managed model where we are the IT department, right?

 **Jason S** 8:33

Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 8:34

Everything from help desk to strategy and consulting project work on top of all that, all the security overlay on that, so we have the majority of our customers are in that size range, and I'd say the majority of them are.

20 to 50 employees. We've got a handful of customers in that group that are like in the hundreds. But when you get into that, what I call mid-market, which is the 250 plus,

That model, a better fit is a co-managed model where we do really a custom-built relationship of where we are, what we like to do is they have...

on site, so you've got, let's say, 300 employees. We prefer that you have, you know, whatever it takes in terms of help desk on site of level one kind of help desk that can run around and, you know, plug in new monitors and, you know, et cetera, et cetera.

 **Jason S** 10:00

Yes.

Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 10:04

manage all the Azure, you know, licensing and servers and everything in the cloud, right? We do all of that. We'll manage the relationship with their SAS vendors. You

know, we'll just, we'll take care of all that stuff like the rest of the IT department would do, you know, if you segregated.

You know, help desk from that, so that's what we like to do in the co-managed model. We do have some where we do a little bit of both, you know, where we where we have a, like I said, that they're all kind of custom at that size. If they've got, you know, what we can do is...

In that co-managed model, we can provide all the security software, we can provide all the management of the machines software, we can provide an escalation point for help, we can provide project management, we can do all those things, but the core in most of those is...

That layer without the help desk, so those are really the two areas that we, in terms of size, that we focus and the services that we're delivering there, and I think that's the majority of where we want to grow.

Um...

Revenue-wise, you know, just easier to handle customers that are a little bit larger. You know, the customers that are small, they need to be big enough, really, that they have that they understand the value of technology. You know, when you're down around the...

10, 15, 20 users, you know, now you're talking about almost a startup kind of level company that really doesn't.

You know, they only have so much money to distribute, and they think, "Well, you know, if this computer stops working, I'll just go get another one at Best Buy or whatever," and that's not our customer. You know, we need customers that are on a, you know, that are on a path that understand that.

 **Jason S** 11:58
Right.

 **Rick Snide** 12:12
technology is important to them and they want to keep moving that direction. So I guess I just wanted to make sure you kind of understood what our...
Size is, and so I guess you know, turning that back toward you, you know, those sound to me, well, the co-managed deals can be fairly large deals, but if you take a...
Let's just say our typical managed customer is, let's say, a 30-person company.
They're going to be in the neighborhood of \$4,500 a month, so you can do that math

pretty quick, and we typically...
Do A three-year deal.

 **Jason S** 13:02
Okay, that's good.

 **Rick Snide** 13:03
So yeah, so they're not huge deals, but the beauty is that they, although they, I think they probably seem huge to some of the customers, they move fairly quickly depending on...
You know, where they, where they are, you know, so, yeah, so I guess you know my thought, my question is...

 **Jason S** 13:24
That sounds great. That's awesome.

 **Rick Snide** 13:31
Um...
Have you have you sold to that size customer before and what do what do you think about that?

 **Jason S** 13:40
So I have, but with all transparency, most of my experience is on the enterprise side. That said, I work with SMB and C all the time, but like you said, you know, I'm working more with like, you know, what I see like a small as like 500 users and up.

 **Rick Snide** 13:47
Yeah.

 **Jason S** 14:00
But I don't, the category, you know, the size doesn't necessarily matter. It's the approach of how you go about doing it. It's A methodology. It's how are you going about it? Because that's what managed services is. It's A methodology. Depending on the size of the customer, then you can customize how we go about it, how things are done. And most

importantly, like you said, what the customer understands about technology, about managed services. That is the most important thing, and that's what I've gleaned over the years. So sounds good to me. I know I obviously would want to understand a bit more, but I understand the motto very well. So



Rick Snide 14:25

Mhm.

Mhm, mhm.

The how much?

How much prospecting do you do on your own right now?



Jason S 14:46

all of it. I'm a hunter. I'm a hunter. I go out and get **** done. Pardon my language. I, you know, I do all my own prospecting. I think I've gotten in the past year and a half, three leads. Everything else has been self-generated and that's just the way it is. I have no,



Rick Snide 14:48

Yeah, yeah.

Yeah.

Mmh.

Mhm.



Jason S 15:04

I enjoy prospecting because I own the process from start to finish. And if I can't close that deal, then I shouldn't be in sales. So that was a long answer to 100%.



Rick Snide 15:10

Mhm.

Mhm, mhm.

Yeah, that you're doing it. The so, so what do you think about this prospecting for, you know, these SMB customers? You know, like I said, they're probably, you know, I know if you go and look at the like the government census of businesses, you know, there's like...

 **Jason S** 15:18

Yep, talking.

 **Rick Snide** 15:37

You know, I'm kind of pulling these numbers out of the air because I haven't really looked at them in a while, but you know, there's like...

97% of companies are like, you know, under 25 and under 25 employees and like 75% of them are under 10 employees. So it's like, it's like a very small,

 **Jason S** 16:01

Yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 16:06

Percentage that are our target, but they end up being, you know, it's a, you know, of...

there's still a lot of companies, right? But my point really is, is that, you know, we need that chunk there between, you know, we don't really want the, you know, the mom and pop, you know, 5, 10, 15 people kind of companies. You know, the sweet spot is really for fully managed, the sweet spot is

you know, like 35 to 75 or so, you know, where they have a definite need for IT staff, but definitely doesn't fit into a budget for them, right? You know, it's, in fact, it's stupid for them. But the...

 **Jason S** 16:44

Mm.

Right, yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 16:55

Yeah, and I often have said to prospects, the problem is you can, you know, either if you get a good person, you can't keep them because it'll be boring, you know, and no challenge. And most people either get a good person.

and can't keep them, or they get a not so good person and they can't lose them. You know, they won't, they don't leave. And those are actually the people that are often the, you know, the speed bump and getting something done, where they've got

somebody that's got a kingdom they're trying to protect, you know, and they're keeping, you know,

 **Jason S** 17:21

Right, exactly.

Right, exactly.



Rick Snide 17:36

Four servers in the back room that really should be Azure servers, and et cetera, et cetera, right?



Jason S 17:43

Yeah, I've worked in I've worked in that industry before. I actually started, you know, in managed services, going and talking with, you know, small to medium sized businesses, retail businesses, you know, I have a couple of stores. That's what I did. So I understand that thought process. I understand the approach. So yeah, it sounds very interesting to me.



Rick Snide 17:55

Mm mhm.

Yeah, so I mean, this, you know, that obviously to me, the area that we have a gap, you know, is that, you know, all of your energies over the last X years being directed toward channel versus going after the...

25, you know, person to 50 person company, let's say, or to 75 person company to talk to their COO, their office manager, their could be founder, CEO, whatever. And just the amount of volume that's required of prospecting to get to the deals, you know. I guess I'm interested in hearing what you think about that and how you'd go about it too.



Jason S 18:53

In terms of, so...

I mean, aside from cold calling and aside from, you know, using LinkedIn and all that, I'm curious to know what do you provide as a lead mechanism of anything? I mean, do you have HubSpot? Do you have Salesforce? I'm just trying to understand what would be the mechanism besides actually prospecting

a business straight out, which is fine. I mean, obviously, that's what we do. But do you guys provide any of that?



Rick Snide 19:20

Yeah.

Yeah, we have, so we were again a Salesforce partner and we had our entire stack with Salesforce until December of last year. So we've moved off of Salesforce and for marketing, we moved



Jason S 19:28

Cody.



Rick Snide 19:42

to HubSpot. So the front end really would be HubSpot in terms of prospecting and all. We use Sixth Sense. So we've tried.



Jason S 19:43

Okay.

Okay, sure.

Yeah.



Rick Snide 20:14

And LinkedIn, and it really comes down to, you know, trying to...



Jason S 20:14

Hmm.



Rick Snide 20:20

Pull out the, you know, the people to go after out of Sixth Sense, if there's some amount of intent, you know, that comes from that that direction, and just, you know, trying to connect and find them, you know, I think...

You know, it's traditional sales, you know, grinding, I think, you know.



Jason S 20:42

Hello.

So how has it traditionally been, like in terms, I mean, obviously I can cold call with the best of them. I can send as many prospecting emails as anybody can. I can go through LinkedIn, I can go through all that, I can go to events. What has been most successful? What has your salespeople been that have done that has been most successful to generate business?

I'd love to know kind of like more historically what's been successful because everything is different. Prospecting is the same. It's just how you go about it. So I would love to know how, how many sales people would you have right now? I should have asked that before.



Rick Snide 21:20

Yeah, we have zero right now. So we had, we've had sales reps over the years and the, when we had Salesforce and we had the ERP consulting group, we had a sales director, we had

three outside sales reps, we had two inside sales reps, and then the practice directors were kind of technical sales closer people themselves too. Since the beginning of the year, so we had a sales rep that I let go at the beginning of the year. She just hadn't been productive.

It just needed to move on and find somebody else, you know, and I, so between me and really my guy that is my projects team manager, just he and I have been doing it all. I've been, you know...

We've been doing the sales calls, we've been doing, you know, you know, he's the technical part of it of the conversations, depending on how technical it needs to be, and I'm, you know, doing the proposals and you know, kind of doing the final close with with him, so it's, and those those have been...

pretty much those have been half and half referral type ones. And pure, I think one of them came from a website lead, which is really rare. And one or two have been just pure prospecting.

you know, and...

and straight out of Sixth Sense. So, you know, I'd like to be able to tell you, you know, that this is exactly what works and has worked forever. It is, as you know, being in the business, it has changed and changed and changed and changed. And we used to, when we first started doing this,

 **Jason S** 23:04
Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 23:22
And I'm sure it was about, you know, when you were, you know, newer into the into the trenches, you know, you really could call people and you could, you know, you had that, you know, if I made X number of calls, X of them will take and will become, you know, you know, quality conversations of the quality conversations, X will become proposals of the proposals, X becomes closes, right?

 **Jason S** 23:46
Bingo, right? It's right.

 **Rick Snide** 23:46
Close, close wins, yeah, and it just is so much different now of, you know, how many different touches you have to have to get to get to a conversation. The other thing is...
I think, you know, maybe four or five years ago, maybe a little longer, people didn't understand managed services. And so you are kind of educating them on why they need to pay a monthly fee, you know, versus why I can't call my, you know, IT guy every time I have a problem, I have him come out and...
Bill me right, so that ship has sailed now, and really everybody understands paying a monthly fee for the service, but it also means that a decent percentage of the people that you talk to.
Two are on an agreement of some sort, so the model the model is, okay, when's your agreement up? When should I check back with you, right? And and kind of building that conversation, you know, so we've got that, we get we get more RFP kinds of requests to these days of, you know, people.

 **Jason S** 24:44
Mhm.
Right.
Okay.



Rick Snide 25:03

Some of the more, some of the larger businesses, you know, are, you know, are doing RFPs, so, although I think that...

We've we most recently we did win an RFP for a big for a big opportunity, but I would say the RFP the RFP response model is there. They don't they're when they're when they have someone managing an RFP.



Jason S 25:22

No.



Rick Snide 25:37

They typically are shopping on price, and we're not the lowest price provider; we're like white glove, high quality, high touch kind of service, so if that's there, Emma, we're...



Jason S 25:40

Mhm.



Rick Snide 25:56

Probably not gonna be a good fit for them, and you know, without at least without having a good opportunity to to talk about how this service is really not the same as this service, right? So...



Jason S 26:09

No, I totally understand. And that makes perfect sense to me. Sorry, my camera just got a little darker. Hopefully you can see me.



Rick Snide 26:14

No, no, no, you're good.



Jason S 26:17

That's really interesting. That helps me out a lot to understand, you know, where your process is, what you guys are doing, and how you're going about, you know, your go-to model is quite interesting. I guess, you know, I would want...

I'd have to understand more about what you're doing, you know, to understand how the prospecting would work. Obviously, aside from, like you said, just picking up the phone and calling, it's not going to work. Those days are done. You're not going to get a hold of anybody. Nobody has the IDs anymore. If they do, they don't answer them. It's all, you know, be, you know, bring your own device. So that kind of goes down to the



Rick Snide 26:49

Mhm.



Jason S 26:52

You know the prospecting through, obviously, social medias, events. Obviously, you know, playing in a plain old email, but there's other ways to go about doing it. I just would know, you know, like a 20 person organization would absolutely need managed services, but would they need the white glove or would they just need like a, that's what I'm kind of, because right now one of the things that I struggle with with my company



Rick Snide 27:10

Mhm.

Mhm.



Jason S 27:17

is when it comes to services, they only offer a white glove. That's it. So if a customer isn't willing to pay that high fee, but they need IT, there's no other option. So would you, is there an option to, I don't want to say drop it down to like a basic, but would that be



Rick Snide 27:21

Mhm.

Mhm.



Jason S 27:34

applicable or even entertained.



Rick Snide 27:39

You know.

There isn't now an option for that. You know, I do think that, you know, we do have to evolve and I do think that...



Jason S 27:44

OK.

Yes.



Rick Snide 27:53

I do think that we need to consider something along those lines because, you know, I feel like...

you know, the company of the future, not ours, but our customers, will have no real demand for support for the workstation at the workstation level, you know, and by that I mean...

If.

You know, we all have excellent internet service, and we have all SaaS-based services that we're using, right? We don't really have a heavy-duty laptop. We've got, you know, a nice big screen with a good internet connection. I think the demand...

You know, goes off a cliff for help desk level one support of things related to hardware, and you know that in that my, you know, whatever you know doesn't work, and so I think that level one is drying up.

In fact, we've got a big mission to replace level one with, you know, automation or AI or whatever. So I think that's drying up and I think I do think that.

That we want to be able to offer a security-first model that is kind of above that, that is identity management and all the other security pieces that people need, but doesn't really need.

To provide that underlying support, so, as an example, I could see a twenty-five person company, let's just say, or a fifty-person company having all kind of internet machines, let's just call them that.

that really, if something stops working with them, they just unplug this stupid thing and plug a different one in, right? Which is what you can really do now if your systems are set up, you know, correctly, right? You don't really need a specific computer. I mean, I could log on to somebody else's laptop.

With my credentials, and it would look like my machine right now, and I think that's the way it's going to be, so I think we're driving toward what will be kind of what you're saying is that they don't really...

 **Jason S** 30:21
Sure.

 **Rick Snide** 30:36
in a different sort of way. They don't need the white glove service because they don't need white glove service, right? They still have it, you know, they still have all the security layers and all of that, you know, and maybe even white glove available to them at some fashion, right?

 **Jason S** 30:53
Correct. Right, exactly. But when you say white glove, people are like, I don't need white glove. I, no, I just need a little. And next thing you know, I need a white glove. You know, you're like, oh, Jesus, oh, you know, oh, you please, what do I pay now? Oh my God, I can't handle, I don't know what, I didn't even know I was having this problem.

 **Rick Snide** 30:55
But yeah, yeah.
Right.
Right.
Right, right, right.
Right, right.
Right, right.

 **Jason S** 31:14
That's why we're here. And so that's what I'm, so that's good to know. So, and that's interesting that the, I would say, I don't want to say non-white glove, but let's say like tier one is going away. That's really interesting because you're right, there isn't any actual hardware or, you know, servers and all this. It's all,

 **Rick Snide** 31:16

Right, right.

Mhm.

Mhm, mhm.

 **Jason S** 31:36

Security base, it's all operation, it's all user, and you know they they have a remote sales team that's you know spread across the globe, but they don't have an IT team.

 **Rick Snide** 31:37

Yeah.

Right.

Right.

Right, right.

 **Jason S** 31:47

So that's what I'm seeing now. And when I'm working with Azure, which I'm working with Azure quite a bit, I'm seeing a lot of companies not even sure how to deploy Azure, how to deploy, how to do all the, how to deploy co-pilot, all these things that nobody really knows how to do.

 **Rick Snide** 31:52

Mm-hmm.

Mhm.

Right.

 **Jason S** 32:06

They're trying to manage services because IT, because not all, like you said, not all companies need a full-time IT staff.

 **Rick Snide** 32:13

Right, right. And the staff that they do have, there's no way they can learn this stuff fast enough to be able to deploy it successfully. You know, there's just no way. Yeah, yeah. So I think that's really where we're going. You know, I think.

 **Jason S** 32:22

Thank you.

That's it. They need third parties, right?



Rick Snide 32:32

Um...

You know, I think a lot of this is still kind of in its infancy, right? I think, you know, getting, bridging people from where they are now with, you know, we've got laptops that aren't, you know, that are four years old that they need to be replacing every four years and, you know, and getting

To that internet computer, right, that doesn't isn't a high-powered computer, it's a connection to the internet, right? I think I think there's a, you know, there's a transition between here and there, and that's, you know, what we wanna do is figure out how to deliver a more cost-effective level one.



Jason S 33:01

Exactly, exactly.



Rick Snide 33:15

either by automating it or by, you know, employing AI, you know.

Right now, what we're working on is employing AI at the technician level to help them move faster on customer problems. But ultimately, the goal is, how do we get rid of them having to deal with those problems and have them...

You know, be delivering higher value services to the to the customers, you know, you know, ultimately, you know, kind of what you're saying of, you know, maybe we have managed, you know...

Copilot consultants of we're gonna provide this level of support to you to see that you're continually employing Copilot in the best way for your organization or whatever.



Jason S 34:14

Exactly. Or whatever. Right, exactly.



Rick Snide 34:15

Right, yeah, yeah, I don't wanna get back into hourly work. I mean, project work is, I mean, we'll never get away from project work, and I don't wanna not do project

work, but I don't wanna move away from an hourly or a...
a managed monthly recurring revenue model to, let's hope we get people to sign
SOWs for projects this month, right?

 **Jason S** 34:43

Oh my God, change orders. That's a W's. That's all I ever hear all day. Oh, that's a W,
change orders, change order. And you're right.

 **Rick Snide** 34:46

Yeah.

Yeah.

 **Jason S** 34:51

Hourly is, it's an administrative nightmare. It's not only human error, it's
administration, and then it's, you're basically working for the hour. And that's not
scalable. We're having the same issue right now with the government. It's not
scalable. So I'm with you on that.

 **Rick Snide** 34:53

Yeah.

Yeah.

Yeah.

Yeah.

Yeah, yeah, yeah, you're exactly right. I think it's a challenge and I think we need
project work because we, you know, but I want to have project work that drives
recurring revenue. You know, we're going to, you know, do a, you know, an X hour
project to implement co-pilot.

 **Jason S** 35:23

Yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 35:29

And then, you know, although I don't think we get, I don't think we get licensing on
Copilot, but as an example, you know, that kind of thing.

 **Jason S** 35:32

Yeah.

So, and you don't get licensing on co-pilot, what do you mainly, so what are the services that are mainly being asked to be managed? And I know that's a silly question, but I want to understand what is the, what's the hottest thing right now that you're seeing that is driving customers to your managed services?

 **Rick Snide** 36:00

Yeah, the typically it's a couple of different.

A couple of different areas, um, the, you know...

Probably the biggest pain that drives them to us is poor service that they're getting right now. You know, of, you know, if they have settled on somebody based on price, you know, I derisively refer to as...

two guys and a dog, you know, that, you know, they do a, those guys, I mean, all of these guys do a great job for a period of time, right? Like if you're their only customer or you're one of five customers of theirs, they can probably do a good job for you. But when they have 10 customers now.

 **Jason S** 36:32

Yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 36:50

You know, now you know they can't handle two problems at once, right?

 **Jason S** 36:55

They don't have the, oh, we have to go get a subcontractor, see our subcontractor, see our subcontractor, see our subcontractor, who the hell is this guy or girl or gal or whatever. And I'm dealing with that again. I'm living it now. I'm out there selling, you know, opportunities and then, oh, well, we don't have a person to fulfill that.

 **Rick Snide** 36:58

All right.

Yeah, yeah, right.

Mhm.

Yeah.

 **Jason S** 37:12

Did you want to tell me that after before I close the deal or afterwards? I mean, and now we've got to go get them. Like, so basically we're subbing, we're a subcontractor to another company who's subbing out. So that makes, so we're two-stepping it. And then the profit margin becomes zero.

 **Rick Snide** 37:15

Yeah, yeah.

Mhm.

Yeah, zero, yeah, yeah, so we have, that's probably one driver is, you know, they're in a dissatisfaction for support of for support if they've had a security incident, you know, that will drive them to looking for somebody, and we've...

And I think we have a really good track record in helping customers implement good security. The...

I think those are probably the two biggest ones. I would say sometimes it's not even, not really pain-related, which those tend to move slower, of course.

but they just, you know, they feel like they've outgrown, you know, the particular vendor, you know, and they don't, you know, they've heard from other people that they should be getting something, you know, or, you know, whatever, and you know, now their agreement's going to be up and they think, well, maybe we ought to look around.

and see.

 **Jason S** 38:41

Do you mainly do Central Ohio, Columbus? I mean, what is what would you say if you're?

 **Rick Snide** 38:46

It.

Yeah, Central Ohio is is is our is our main area we have, we go, you know.

 **Jason S** 38:49
Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 38:58
a ways out from Central Ohio and we have some customers with branches in other states and where they've pulled us along, you know, they've opened another branch or maybe the CFO or whatever moved from this company to DC and said, hey, can you take care of my people here in DC and we're like, yeah, yeah, yeah, we can do that. And so we can do, especially if they have somebody that is competent enough to unplug something and plug something in and that kind of thing, it's really.

 **Jason S** 39:36
It's just so funny to hear you plug it in. It's truly that sometimes. It's unbelievable.

 **Rick Snide** 39:38
Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah. It's, yeah. So, I mean, we will send somebody and we'll charge them, you know, you know, to do that. Well, either we can send our own person, you know, depending on how far it is, or we'll contract to somebody local to just go do something for us, you know, and we have, like, we do have a customer in DC, and so we've got a relationship with really a one-person shop there in DC that they had used before, and we just use them and pay them hourly, you know, if we need them to go out. You know, replace a, you know, an access point or do something like that, but in general, we do, we handle all of our, all of our...
Uh...
On-site work, and we have about, we don't really sell it this way if we can get, if we can avoid it now. We used to always sell our agreements with some packaged on-site amount, and that's really, really a pain.
But it does, it does provide some amount of um...

 **Jason S** 40:49
Yeah.

Visually.

Sorry.



Rick Snide 40:54

Now, some amount of stickiness, I guess would be the word, you know, of, you know, they have a face to the services, as opposed to seeing IT support as, you know, the electric company or something, right? So, you know, if...



Jason S 41:00

Sure.

M.



Rick Snide 41:13

Susie comes out there, you know, for a half a day once a month, and that's mostly what they are. They're half a day once a month or, you know, a full day once a month or, you know, something like that. We still do a fair amount of that. And when we redo agreements, you know, when we rewrite agreements, renew agreements, we typically



Jason S 41:25

Right.



Rick Snide 41:34

try to take that out, you know, to keep, you know, maybe to keep their price the same, but take that out, you know, or something along those lines.



Jason S 41:37

Okay.

Yeah, you know.

And people aren't calling you to like pull cable or like put up new sites like, okay, good.



Rick Snide 41:52

No, no. And if we did, we'll, you know, contract somebody to go run cable. We've got a couple of partners that we can use for that. But no, we don't do that. We don't, I

mean, we do put in, you know, switches and firewalls and things like that.
But we don't know, we don't like run cable and do things like that.

 **Jason S** 42:18

Okay, good, because I know there's some companies, I mean, nobody wants to be a, you know, a cable, well, I shouldn't say nobody, it's, that's very much commodity driven, so.

 **Rick Snide** 42:27

Oh yeah, yeah, yeah, and the people that are doing it, yeah, like you said, it's a price business for sure, you know, and they do it well at the low price, you know.

 **Jason S** 42:34

Yeah, and.

Sure, let them do it all day long. Okay. Yeah, well, right. It's just, you know, laborious.

 **Rick Snide** 42:39

It's not that hard.

Yeah.

 **Jason S** 42:46

Well, this is real. I mean, I'm really interested in hearing more about it. Moving on, I do have to get a call into a call at 9. I have to get ready for it. I apologize. I would love to keep talking. I find this very, very interesting. I hope you do as well, but you know, I want to make sure that you're seeing my background fit the role. And I want to make sure we're on the same page with that, because I

 **Rick Snide** 42:52

Yeah, sure.

Mhm, mhm.

 **Jason S** 43:05

You know, wanna make sure we're moving forward, so...

 **Rick Snide** 43:07

Yeah, and you know, I guess the other thing too that we haven't talked about is what your expectations are for compensation and how that would work. So I don't know if you have some thoughts you want to share on that.

JS **Jason S** 43:22

I just do it for free. I just love this. You know, I'm an altruistic. I'm independently wealthy. You didn't know. I live in Grandview. You didn't know that? One of those giant houses. Yeah. I can take my house is probably the size of your living room. So compensation, just, you know, give a little bit of background. You know, I'm a single dad, two kids.

 **Rick Snide** 43:23

Good. You're my favorite kind of guy.
Heather.
Yeah.

JS **Jason S** 43:41

So base salary is important to me to keep my lights on and all that, benefits. Right now, and I think I told Amy this, my salary is high because they didn't include benefits and for other reasons. Well, I'm at 145. But I am absolutely willing to take a smaller base salary as long as the commissions will come in pretty quickly and that there is going to be a ramp of sales quickly. I can handle that. I can absorb a lower salary. But right now, the reason I'm leaving is that the sales that I'm working on, the enterprise sales are taking years, years and years and years and years. And as I said, my quota is 2.4 million.

 **Rick Snide** 44:16

Mhm.
Yeah.

JS **Jason S** 44:34

At year to date, I'm around 42%. But I do not see this company working to make that 100%, which is why I'm leading. And I'd like to make a move pretty quickly. So compensation wise, I need to be between 125 and 135.



Rick Snide 44:37

M.

Mm-hmm.

Mhm.

Gotcha.



Jason S 44:52

At least to start.



Rick Snide 44:54

Mhm.



Jason S 44:54

And then once sales start coming through, I'm okay with even lowering my base salary as long as I'm making the commissions that are coming in. That is the most important thing to me because that's how I make my money. So that's where I need to be. Obviously, benefits are important, but not as important as it is.



Rick Snide 45:02

Mhm.

Yeah, yeah.

R.



Jason S 45:15

To make sales, so.



Rick Snide 45:15

Yeah, yeah. Well, we have decent benefits too. The, when you said one, you said 125 to 145, are you talking total comp or are you talking base?



Jason S 45:26

Base.



Rick Snide 45:28

Yeah, that's pretty far outside of where we would be. I mean, I think we're talking, you know, we typically would do like 75, 80 base with a, you know, with a total comp, not a cap on the total comp, but the expectation of being...

 **Jason S** 45:32
Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 45:47
You know, around 150 anyway, you know, depending, depending on, you know, obviously, you know, how fast you can get the ball rolling, but...

 **Jason S** 45:50
Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 46:00
Yeah.

 **Jason S** 46:00
Yeah, I don't know. I mean, I get it. Believe me, I just don't, that would not work for me at this point. If that was, if that's the base, because it's just, it's, it wouldn't, I couldn't live on it right now with my two kids. It just wouldn't, at least not for the, you know, for the first couple of months. So.

 **Rick Snide** 46:13
Yeah, yeah.
Yeah, I mean, I'd be interested in talking about doing a ramp, you know, of, you know, some, some, some, you know, recoverable draw type model or, you know, something like that, you know, that would, that would, I know that that's a...

 **Jason S** 46:22
Sure.
Be creative.

 **Rick Snide** 46:35

a heavy lift to, you know, I mean, if it takes, you know, four to six months to get rolling, you know, it's a, that's a big, it's a big hit on lack of commission.

 **Jason S** 46:48

Correct, you know, and that, and I understand, you know, I'm just, I'm not, and I'm not saying I'm at the most senior level, but I'm at a level now where I really.

 **Rick Snide** 46:49

Mm-hmm.

 **Jason S** 46:57

Really need to stay within that that they salary just to keep.
you know, things going the right way without having to worry. So, but I'd be willing to talk if we can meet somewhere in the middle. If you'd like to continue, I know you're probably interviewing quite a few people that may be a little less, I don't want to say senior, probably I feel like I'm dating myself, but maybe a little bit more on their, you know, mid-career, but I'm

 **Rick Snide** 47:06

Mhm.

 **Jason S** 47:22

I'm pretty far along and I want to stay there, so anyway, you get...

 **Rick Snide** 47:24

Yeah, yeah, yeah, I totally understand. I think the thing for me, Jason, is to understand how you make that transition from enterprise sales to SMB sales and the amount of prospecting and hunting that has to occur, you know, for you to be successful at that.

You know, that's the part that I think I really want to understand and want you to think about, want you to think about as well.

 **Jason S** 47:48

Sure.

Absolutely. Yeah. And I, that's a fair question. Very fair. I'm coming from enterprise.

It's a totally different methodology, but it's still sales. It's still prospecting. It's just a question of how you're doing it. Because I do all my own prospecting, but I attend a tremendous amount of events, a lot of industry events, a lot of user groups.



Rick Snide 47:54

Yeah.

Yeah.

Mm.

Mhm.

Yeah.

Mm-hmm.



Jason S 48:12

that is a good mechanism for me to get opportunities because you're in front of people. Nothing's, and then you then, as you said, that's the stickiness. So anyway, you've been, you've been in this long enough, you understand it. But I also, with all that said, I don't want to put you in any situation where you're financially, I don't want to say in trouble, but you know,



Rick Snide 48:18

Yeah.

Yeah.



Jason S 48:33

concern that I may not give you the high risk, high reward. I want to make sure because I don't want to put you in a situation.



Rick Snide 48:36

Yeah, yeah, for sure.

For sure, for sure. Well, I appreciate talking with you. I'll let you roll here, give you a couple minutes to get ready for your 9:00. And we'll let's both simmer on this just a little bit and get back and get back and figure out if we should have another conversation after you think about what we've talked about.



Jason S 48:46

Thank you.

Sure. Sounds good.

Sounds good, Rick. Thank you. Appreciate you. Have a great day. Enjoy your day.

Thank you. Take care.



Rick Snide 49:00

All right.

Alright, you too. Thanks, Jason. See ya.

● **Rick Snide** stopped transcription